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Force feedback trigger for handheld device

Abstract

As disclosed herein, a system may comprise a handheld device in electronic communication with a controller. The handheld device may comprise a housing defining an internal cavity and an orifice providing access to the internal cavity. A trigger may comprise an external and an internal surface. The trigger may be oriented to cover the orifice. A transfer member may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the internal surface of the trigger. A force sensor may be oriented in the internal cavity and may engage a distal end of the transfer member and the internal surface of the trigger. A transfer roller may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the distal end of the transfer member. A cam may be oriented in the internal cavity and may engage the transfer member. A motor may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the cam.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application claims the benefit of priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(e) to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/351,780, filed Jun. 13, 2022, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety for all purposes.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure is directed toward augmented reality/virtual reality (AR/VR) handheld hardware. More particularly, the present disclosure relates to augmenting haptic feedback for a trigger in a handheld device.

BACKGROUND

(2) In an augmented reality/virtual reality (AR/VR) environment, the tactile feel and manipulation of an object can be difficult to simulate. These tangible characteristics of an object can include the object's weight, rigidity, or texture. Simulating these characteristics can become increasingly difficult when simulating an action on the object in the AR/VR environment. For example, if a user is squeezing a tennis ball in the environment, a more realistic simulation would be able to capture the user's natural perception of squeezing a tennis ball when manipulating their handheld device.

SUMMARY

(3) The subject disclosure provides for an augmented reality/virtual reality (AR/VR) system that may provide haptic feedback to a user of a handheld device of the system. The disclosure concerns the problem of effectively simulating actions performed on objects in an AR/VR environment. The disclosure addresses the problem by configuring a system capable of receiving an input force from a trigger of the handheld device, determining an output force to be delivered to the user, and delivering the output force to the user.

(4) According to certain aspects of the present disclosure, a system may include a handheld device and a controller. The handheld device may be in electronic communication with the controller. The handheld device may include a housing that defines an internal cavity and that defines an orifice providing access to the internal cavity. A trigger may include an external surface and an internal surface, and the trigger may be oriented to cover the orifice. A transfer member may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the internal surface of the trigger. A force sensor may be oriented in the internal cavity and engaged to a distal end of the transfer member and the internal surface of the trigger. A transfer roller may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the distal end of the transfer member. A cam may be oriented in the internal cavity and configured to engage the transfer member. A motor may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the cam.

(5) According to other aspects of the present disclosure, a system may include a handheld device. The handheld device may include a housing that defines an internal cavity and that defines an orifice providing access to the internal cavity. A trigger may include an external surface and an internal surface, and the trigger may be oriented to cover the orifice. A transfer member may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the internal surface of the trigger. A force sensor may be oriented in the internal cavity and engaged to a distal end of the transfer member and the internal surface of the trigger. A transfer roller may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the distal end of the transfer member. A cam may be oriented in the internal cavity and configured to engage the transfer member. A motor may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the cam. A controller may be in electronic communication with the handheld device. The controller may receive, from the force sensor, a force input from the trigger. Based on the force input, the controller may determine a response force to be applied to the transfer member. The controller may cause the motor to initiate a rotation, transferring a rotational force through the cam and applying the response force to the transfer member.

(6) According to yet other aspects of the present disclosure, a system may include a handheld device. The handheld device may include a housing that defines an internal cavity and that defines an orifice providing access to the internal cavity. A trigger may include an external surface and an internal surface, and the trigger may be oriented to cover the orifice. A transfer member may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the internal surface of the trigger. A force sensor may be oriented in the internal cavity and engaged to a distal end of the transfer member and the internal surface of the trigger. A transfer roller may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the distal end of the transfer member. A cam may be oriented in the internal cavity and configured to engage the transfer member. A motor may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the cam. A gear train may be coupled to the motor and the cam. The gear train may adjust a rotational speed or a torque applied to the cam by the motor. A controller may be in electronic communication with the handheld device. The controller may receive, from the force sensor, a force input from the trigger. Based on the force input, the controller may determine a response force to be applied to the

transfer member. The controller may cause the motor to initiate a rotation, transferring a rotational force through the cam and applying the response force to the transfer member.

(7) It is understood that other configurations of the subject technology will become readily apparent to those skilled in the art from the following detailed description, wherein various configurations of the subject technology are shown and described by way of illustration. As will be realized, the subject technology is capable of other and different configurations and its several details are capable of modification in various other respects, all without departing from the scope of the subject technology. Accordingly, the drawings and detailed description are to be regarded as illustrative in nature and not as restrictive.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The accompanying drawings, which are included to provide further understanding and are incorporated in and constitute a part of this specification, illustrate disclosed embodiments and together with the description serve to explain the principles of the disclosed embodiments. In the drawings:
- (2) FIG. 1 illustrates an isometric cutaway of the internal components of a system comprising a handheld device, according to certain aspects of the disclosure;
- (3) FIG. 2 illustrates a side cutaway view of the internal components of the system comprising the handheld device shown in FIG. 1;
- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates a block diagram of the electronic components and connections of the system comprising the handheld device shown in FIGS. 1 and 2;
- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates a block diagram of a network architecture including the handheld device shown in FIGS. 1 and 2;
- (6) FIG. 5 illustrates a process flow diagram of a method that may be performed by the system comprising a handheld device and a controller shown in FIGS. 1 to 4;
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates an isometric view of a force feedback trigger mechanism of a system comprising a handheld device, according to other aspects of the disclosure;
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates a side cutaway view of the force feedback trigger mechanism of the system comprising a handheld device shown in FIG. 6;
- (9) FIG. 8 illustrates a reverse side cutaway view of the worm gear and the motor of the force feedback trigger mechanism of the system comprising a handheld device shown in FIGS. 6 and 7; and
- (10) FIG. 9 illustrates a block diagram of an exemplary computer system with which aspects of the subject technology may be implemented.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (11) Without engaging a person's sense of touch, augmented reality/virtual reality (AR/VR) systems are limited in the immersive experience they can provide that person. Haptic feedback technology has the potential to improve user satisfaction with AR/VR systems by bridging the divide between the real world and the digital world. However, it is difficult to faithfully simulate an object's tangible characteristics (e.g., weight, rigidity, texture) when the object is acted on in an AR/VR environment. The technology disclosed herein provides for augmenting a handheld AR/VR controller trigger with force feedback haptic technology.
- (12) The detailed description set forth below describes various configurations of the subject technology and is not intended to represent the only configurations in which the subject technology may be practiced. The detailed description includes specific details for the purpose of providing a thorough understanding of the subject technology. Accordingly, dimensions may be provided in regards to certain aspects as non-limiting examples. However, it will be apparent to those skilled in

the art that the subject technology may be practiced without these specific details. In some instances, well-known structures and components are shown in block diagram form in order to avoid obscuring the concepts of the subject technology.

(13) It is to be understood that the present disclosure includes examples of the subject technology and does not limit the scope of the included clauses. Various aspects of the subject technology will now be disclosed according to particular but non-limiting examples. Various embodiments described in the present disclosure may be carried out in different ways and variations, and in accordance with a desired application or implementation.

(14) In the following detailed description, numerous specific details are set forth to provide a full understanding of the present disclosure. It will be apparent, however, to one ordinarily skilled in the art, that embodiments of the present disclosure may be practiced without some of the specific details. In other instances, well-known structures and techniques have not been shown in detail so as not to obscure the disclosure.

(15) Turning now to the figures, FIG. 1 illustrates an isometric cutaway of the internal components of a system **100** comprising a handheld device **101**, according to certain aspects of the disclosure. The handheld device **101** includes a housing **102**; an internal cavity **104**; an orifice **106**; a trigger **108**; a transfer member **110**; a cam **112**; a motor **114**, which may include a gear train **208** (depicted in FIG. 3); a transfer roller **116**; a trigger position sensor **124**; and a cam position sensor **206**. The housing **102** may define the internal cavity **104**, where the internal components of the handheld device **101** may be seated. The housing **102** may define the orifice **106**, which may provide access to the internal cavity **104**. The trigger **108** may include an external surface and an internal surface, and the trigger **108** may be oriented to cover the orifice **106**. The trigger **108** may be the component of the handheld device **101** where a user applies a force, causing a portion of the trigger to recede into the internal cavity **104**. The transfer member **110** may be oriented in the internal cavity **104** and coupled to the internal surface of the trigger **108**. The receding trigger **108** may initiate motion in the transfer member **110**.

(16) The cam **112** may convert at least rotational or oscillatory motion to at least linear or translational motion. The transfer member **110** (also known as a follower, a cam follower, or a track follower) may include a translating or oscillating lever that may engage the cam **112** directly, indirectly, or a combination thereof, and may follow the profile of the cam **112** as the cam **112** rotates or translates. The motion of the transfer member **110** may be based on the profile of the cam **112**. The cam **112** may include a disk cam (also known as a plate cam or a radial cam), wherein the transfer member **110** may move radially from the center of rotation of the cam **112**; a linear or translational cam, wherein the cam **112** translates rather than rotates; a pear-shaped cam, wherein the transfer member **110** may remain stationary for approximately half the rotation of the cam **112** and then rise and fall for approximately the other half of the rotation; a circular cam (also known as an eccentric cam), wherein the transfer member **110** smoothly reciprocates; a heart-shaped cam, wherein the transfer member **110** may move back and forth with uniform velocity; or any standard shape (e.g., star, snail) or nonstandard shape appropriate to affect the proper motion of the transfer member **112**. The transfer member **112** may include an oscillating (or rotating) follower; a translating (or reciprocating) follower; a roller follower; a spherical-faced follower; a knife-edge follower; a flat-faced (or mushroom) follower; or any standard or nonstandard shape or configuration appropriate to affect proper engagement with the cam **112** and proper motion of the transfer member **110**.

(17) In further aspects, the motor **114** may include a rotational motor configured to cause the cam **112** to rotate about an axis. In further aspects, the trigger position sensor **124** may be a Hall effect sensor. In further aspects, the Hall effect sensor may provide data regarding a simulated action in an augmented reality/virtual reality (AR/VR) environment.

(18) FIG. 2 illustrates a side cutaway view of the internal components of the system **100** comprising the handheld device **101** shown in FIG. 1. The handheld device **101** includes the

housing **102**, the trigger **108**, the transfer member **110**, the cam **112**, the motor **114**, a transfer roller **116**, and a force sensor **120**. The force sensor **120** may include one or more load cells (e.g., capacitive load cells, inductive load cells, hydraulic load cells, magnetostrictive load cells, piezoelectric crystal load cells, pneumatic load cells, strain gage load cells), force sensing resistors (FSR's), optical force sensors, strain gauges, ultrasonic force sensors, or the like. The force sensor **120** may be oriented in the internal cavity and engaged to a distal end of the transfer member **110** and the internal surface of the trigger **108**. The transfer roller **116** may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the distal end of the transfer member **110**. The cam **112** may be oriented in the internal cavity and configured to engage the transfer member **110**. The motor **114** may be oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the cam **112**. The cam **112** may be coupled to the motor **114**, wherein the motor **114** may cause the cam to rotate.

(19) FIG. **6** illustrates an isometric view of a force feedback trigger mechanism of a system **600** comprising a handheld device, according to other aspects of the disclosure. The force feedback trigger mechanism includes a trigger **608**, wherein triggers **108** and **608** may be similar, the same, or different components; a transfer member **610**, wherein transfer members **110** and **610** may be similar, the same, or different components; a transfer roller **616**, wherein transfer rollers **116** and **616** may be similar, the same, or different components; and a motor **614**, wherein motors **114** and **614** may be similar, the same, or different components. The system **600** also includes a worm wheel **640**.

(20) FIG. **7** illustrates a side cutaway view of the force feedback trigger mechanism of the system **600** comprising a handheld device shown in FIG. **6**. The force feedback trigger mechanism includes a cam **612**, wherein cams **112** and **612** may be similar, the same, or different components; a force sensor **620**, wherein force sensors **120** and **620** may be similar, the same, or different components; a trigger position sensor **624**, wherein trigger position sensors **124** and **624** may be similar, the same, or different components; and a worm gear including a worm wheel **640** and a worm **642**. The force sensor **620** may be engaged to a distal end of the transfer member **610** and the internal surface of the trigger **608**. The transfer roller **616** may be coupled to the distal end of the transfer member **610**. The cam **612** may be configured to engage the transfer member **610** and the worm gear. FIG. **8** illustrates a reverse side cutaway view of the worm gear and the motor of the force feedback trigger mechanism of the system comprising a handheld device shown in FIGS. **6** and **7**. The worm wheel **640** may be coupled to the worm **642**, which may be coupled to the motor **614** by a shaft of the motor **614**. The motor **614**, via the worm gear, may cause the cam **612** to rotate. In further aspects, a spring **630** may provide spring force to return the trigger **608** from a recessed position, which may be caused by a user applying force to the trigger **608**. In further aspects, the trigger **608** may comprise a localized haptic motor **632**.

(21) According to certain aspects of the disclosure as illustrated in FIGS. **1** and **2**, the linear force applied by a user to the trigger **108** may be converted to a rotational force via the transfer member **110**. At a proximal end of the transfer member **110**, the transfer member **110** may be coupled to an internal surface of the trigger **108**. The coupling between the transfer member **110** and the trigger **108** may allow the transfer member **110** to rotate. In further aspects, a first section of the distal end of the transfer member **110** may engage the force sensor **120** and a second section of the distal end of the transfer member **110** may be coupled to the transfer roller **116**. The rotational force transferred through the transfer member **110** may cause the transfer roller **116** coupled at the distal end of the transfer member **110** to engage the cam **112**. In a further aspect, the transfer roller **116** may comprise a roller bearing configured to maintain contact and roll over a surface. As the transfer member **110** rotates, the transfer roller **116** at the distal end of the transfer member **110** may roll along the external surface of the cam **112**. The motion of the cam **112** may also be controlled by the motor **114**. The motor **114** may initiate a rotation of the cam **112**. As the motor **114** initiates a rotation, the rotating cam **112** may produce a force that may be transferred back to the transfer member **110**, resulting in haptic feedback to a user squeezing the trigger **108**. According to the

other aspects of the disclosure as illustrated in FIGS. 6-8, where the components are similar or the same, similar or the same configurations may be arranged or actions may be performed.

(22) FIG. 3 illustrates a block diagram of an electrical communication system **200** comprising the handheld device **101**, shown in FIGS. 1 and 2, and a controller **202**. The controller **202** may be a computing device that is in electrical communication with the motor **114**, the force sensor **120**, and the cam position sensor **206**. The cam position sensor **206** may include a contacting sensor (e.g., rotary potentiometer) or a non-contacting sensor. The cam position sensor **206** may include one or more of a variable reluctance sensor, a magneto-resistive element (MRE) sensor, a pass-through sensor, a Hall effect sensor, a magnetic-less Hall effect sensor, a rotary variable differential transformer (RVDT), or the like. In further aspects, the cam position sensor **206** may include an encoder, wherein the encoder is configured to detect the rotation of the cam and to convert at least rotary position to electronic signals. During operation of the handheld device **101**, the controller **202** may first receive force inputs from the trigger **108** via the force sensor **120**. In response, the controller **202** may cause the motor **114** to initiate a rotation, transferring a rotational force through the cam **112** and applying a response force to the transfer member **110**. In a further aspect, the oblong shape of the cam **112** cross-section may facilitate a rate change in force transfer from the motor **114** while the transfer roller **116** rolls along the shape of the cam **112**. In a further aspect, the rate of change for the cam **112** rotation may be adjusted by switching a driving gear (not shown) in the gear train **208**. The gear train **208**, which may be coupled to the motor **114** and the cam **112**, may be a set of rotational gears that may be configured to adjust a rotational speed or a torque applied to the cam by the motor, or may allow a user to select a particular gear to vary the torque output and/or the rotational speed output. For example, when a user is in an AR/VR environment and is in a simulation of squeezing a tennis ball, the controller may cause the motor **114** and cam **112** to rotate, generating a response resistive force transferred to trigger **108** that is consistent with the responsive force a user would feel when trying to squeeze the tennis ball.

(23) FIG. 4 illustrates a block diagram of the system **100** including the handheld device **101** shown in FIGS. 1 and 2. The system includes a network **405**; a server **410**; a set of AR/VR goggles **415**; a mobile device **420**; an electronic storage **170**; sensors **425**; which include the force sensor **120**, the trigger position sensor **124**, and the cam position sensor **206**; motor **114**; communications module **430**; and the controller **202**, which includes a processor **432**. The processor **432** includes machine-readable instructions **177** that include an input force receiving module **435**, a response force determining module **440**, and a response force outputting module **445**.

(24) The network **405** interconnecting the elements of the system **100** may correspond to a communication network. The communication network may be any one of a local area network (LAN), wide area network (WAN), the Internet, a direct peer-to-peer (P2P) network (e.g., Bluetooth®), indirect P2P network, and the like. The server **410** may correspond to one or more server computers. The server **410** may be located locally or remotely. The server **410** may host one or more applications installed on the handheld device **101**, the AR/VR glasses **150**, or the mobile device **420**. The one or more applications may allow the user to control settings or to provide, collect, or process data gathered by the handheld device **101**, the AR/VR glasses **150**, or the mobile device **420**.

(25) The mobile device **420** may include one or more mobile devices, which may include laptop computers, E-readers, tablets, handheld video gaming consoles, smart watches, smart speakers, and smartphones. The mobile device **420** may host one or more applications that allow the mobile device **420** to operate the handheld device **101** or the AR/VR glasses **415**, or to be operated by the handheld device **101** or the AR/VR glasses **415**.

(26) The AR/VR glasses **415** may include head-worn, tethered, or standalone devices that allow for augmented reality (AR), virtual reality (VR), or mixed reality (MR) experiences. In further aspects, the AR/VR glasses **415** may include a set of augmented reality (AR) glasses. The AR glasses may be transmissive or non-transmissive. The transmissive AR glasses may overlay interactable digital

objects onto a real-world environment. In further aspects, the AR/VR glasses **415** may include a virtual reality (VR) headset. The VR headset may include a head-mounted display that affords a fully immersive visual and audio experience. The VR headset may include cameras that allow a user to perceive the real world on the VR screen as if the user were looking directly at the real world. In further aspects, the AR/VR glasses **415** may include mobile AR devices (e.g., a smartphone). The mobile AR device may host an application that uses one or more of the cameras, sensors, and processing power of the mobile AR device to overlay digital objects and information onto a real-world environment.

(27) The one or more sensors **425** may include at least one of cameras, motion sensors, light sensors, proximity sensors, temperature sensors, biometric sensors, magnetometers, and Global Positioning System (GPS) receivers. The sensors **425** may be physical or virtual, and they may capture real-world elements, virtual world elements, or a combination thereof. The communications module **430** may include radio and antenna hardware or software to send and receive wireless signals via the network **405**, to and from at least one of the server **410**, the AR/VR glasses **415**, and the mobile device **420**.

(28) Processor **432** may be configured to provide information processing capabilities in handheld device **101**. Processor **432** may include one or more processors, which may include one or more control units, arithmetic-logic units (ALU's), and processor registers for the operations of modules **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules. Processor **432** may include one or more of a digital processor, an analog processor, a digital circuit designed to process information, an analog circuit designed to process information, a state machine, and/or other mechanisms for electronically processing information. Although processor **432** is shown in FIG. **4** as a single entity, this is for illustrative purposes only. In some implementations, processor **432** may include a plurality of processing units. These processing units may be physically located within the same device, or processor **432** may represent processing functionality of a plurality of devices operating in coordination. Processor **432** may be configured to execute modules **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules. Processor **432** may be configured to execute modules **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules by software; hardware; firmware; some combination of software, hardware, and/or firmware; and/or other mechanisms for configuring processing capabilities on processor **432**.

(29) As used herein, the term “module” may refer to any component or set of components that perform the functionality attributed to the module. This may include one or more physical processors during execution of processor-readable instructions, the processor-readable instructions, circuitry, hardware, storage media, or any other components. It should be appreciated that although modules **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules are illustrated in FIG. **4** as being implemented within a single processing unit, in implementations in which processor **432** includes multiple processing units, one or more of modules **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules may be implemented remotely from the other modules. The description of the functionality provided by the different modules **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules described below is for illustrative purposes, and is not intended to be limiting, as any of modules **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules may provide more or less functionality than is described. For example, one or more of modules **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules may be eliminated, and some or all of its functionality may be provided by other ones of modules **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules. As another example, processor **432** may be configured to execute one or more additional modules that may perform some or all of the functionality attributed below to one of **435**, **440**, and/or **445**, and/or other modules.

(30) The input force receiving module **435** may receive, via the force sensor **120**, a force input from the trigger **108**. The response force determining module **440** may determine, based on the force input, a response force to be applied to the transfer member. The response force outputting module **445** may cause the motor **114** to initiate a rotation, transferring a rotational force through the cam **112** and applying the response force to the transfer member **110**.

(31) FIG. 5 illustrates a process flow diagram of a method **500** that may be performed by the system **100** comprising the handheld device **101** and the controller **202**, shown in FIGS. 1 to 4. Block **510** describes receiving, via a force sensor (e.g., **120**), a force input from a trigger (e.g., **108**). Block **520** describes determining, based on the force input, a response force to be applied to a transfer member (e.g., **110**). Block **530** describes causing a motor (e.g., **114**) to initiate a rotation, transferring a rotational force through a cam (e.g., **112**) and applying the response force to a transfer member (e.g., **110**).

(32) FIG. 9 illustrates a block diagram of an exemplary computer system **900** with which aspects of the subject technology may be implemented. The computer system **900** includes a processor **905**, wherein processors **432** and **905** may be similar, the same, or different components; a memory **910**; a data storage device **915**, wherein electronic storage **170** and data storage device **915** may be similar, the same, or different components; a bus **920**; an input/output module **925**; a communications module **930**, wherein communications modules **430** and **930** may be similar, the same, or different components; an input device **935**; and an output device **940**. In certain aspects, the computer system **900** may be implemented using hardware or a combination of software and hardware, either in a dedicated server, integrated into another entity, or distributed across multiple entities.

(33) Computer system **900** (e.g., server and/or client) includes a bus **920** or other communication mechanism for communicating information, and a processor **905** coupled with bus **920** for processing information. By way of example, the computer system **900** may be implemented with one or more processors **905**. Processor **905** may be a general-purpose microprocessor, a microcontroller, a Digital Signal Processor (DSP), an Application Specific Integrated Circuit (ASIC), a Field Programmable Gate Array (FPGA), a Programmable Logic Device (PLD), a controller, a state machine, gated logic, discrete hardware components, or any other suitable entity that can perform calculations or other manipulations of information.

(34) Computer system **900** may include, in addition to hardware, code that creates an execution environment for the computer program in question, e.g., code that constitutes processor firmware, a protocol stack, a database management system, an operating system, or a combination of one or more of them stored in an included memory **910**, such as a Random Access Memory (RAM), a flash memory, a Read Only Memory (ROM), a Programmable Read-Only Memory (PROM), an Erasable PROM (EPROM), registers, a hard disk, a removable disk, a CD-ROM, a DVD, or any other suitable storage device, coupled to bus **920** for storing information and instructions to be executed by processor **905**. The processor **905** and the memory **910** may be supplemented by, or incorporated in, special purpose logic circuitry.

(35) The instructions may be stored in the memory **910** and implemented in one or more computer program products, i.e., one or more modules of computer program instructions encoded on a computer readable medium for execution by, or to control the operation of, the computer system **900**, and according to any method well-known to those of skill in the art, including, but not limited to, computer languages such as data-oriented languages (e.g., SQL, dBase), system languages (e.g., C, Objective-C, C++, Assembly), architectural languages (e.g., Java, .NET), and application languages (e.g., PHP, Ruby, Perl, Python). Instructions may also be implemented in computer languages such as array languages, aspect-oriented languages, assembly languages, authoring languages, command line interface languages, compiled languages, concurrent languages, curly-bracket languages, dataflow languages, data-structured languages, declarative languages, esoteric languages, extension languages, fourth-generation languages, functional languages, interactive mode languages, interpreted languages, iterative languages, list-based languages, little languages, logic-based languages, machine languages, macro languages, metaprogramming languages, multiparadigm languages, numerical analysis, non-English-based languages, object-oriented class-based languages, object-oriented prototype-based languages, off-side rule languages, procedural languages, reflective languages, rule-based languages, scripting languages, stack-based languages,

synchronous languages, syntax handling languages, visual languages, Wirth languages, and XML-based languages. Memory **910** may also be used for storing temporary variable or other intermediate information during execution of instructions to be executed by processor **905**.

(36) A computer program as discussed herein does not necessarily correspond to a file in a file system. A program may be stored in a portion of a file that holds other programs or data (e.g., one or more scripts stored in a markup language document), in a single file dedicated to the program in question, or in multiple coordinated files (e.g., files that store one or more modules, subprograms, or portions of code). A computer program may be deployed to be executed on one computer or on multiple computers that are located at one site or distributed across multiple sites and interconnected by a communication network. The processes and logic flows described in this specification can be performed by one or more programmable processors executing one or more computer programs to perform functions by operating on input data and generating output.

(37) Computer system **900** further includes a data storage device **915**, such as a magnetic disk or optical disk, coupled to bus **920** for storing information and instructions. Computer system **900** may be coupled via input/output module **925** to various devices. The input/output module **925** may be any input/output module. Exemplary input/output modules **925** include data ports such as USB ports. The input/output module **925** may be configured to connect to a communications module **930**. Exemplary communications modules **930** include networking interface cards, such as Ethernet cards and modems. In certain aspects, the input/output module **925** is configured to connect to a plurality of devices, such as an input device **935** and/or an output device **940**. Exemplary input devices **935** include a keyboard and a pointing device, e.g., a mouse or a trackball, by which a user may provide input to the computer system **900**. Other kinds of input devices **935** may be used to provide for interaction with a user as well, such as a tactile input device, visual input device, audio input device, or brain-computer interface device. For example, feedback provided to the user can be any form of sensory feedback, e.g., visual feedback, auditory feedback, or tactile feedback, and input from the user can be received in any form, including acoustic, speech, tactile, or brain wave input. Exemplary output devices **940** include display devices such as an LCD (liquid crystal display) monitor, for displaying information to the user.

(38) According to one aspect of the present disclosure, the above-described systems may be implemented using a computer system **900** in response to processor **905** executing one or more sequences of one or more instructions contained in memory **910**. Such instructions may be read into memory **910** from another machine-readable medium, such as data storage device **915**. Execution of the sequences of instructions contained in the memory **910** causes processor **905** to perform the process steps described herein. One or more processors in a multi-processing arrangement may also be employed to execute the sequences of instructions contained in memory **910**. In alternative aspects, hard-wired circuitry may be used in place of or in combination with software instructions to implement various aspects of the present disclosure. Thus, aspects of the present disclosure are not limited to any specific combination of hardware circuitry and software.

(39) Various aspects of the subject matter described in this specification may be implemented in a computing system that includes a back-end component, e.g., such as a data server, or that includes a middleware component, e.g., an application server, or that includes a front-end component, e.g., a client computer having a graphical user interface or a Web browser through which a user may interact with an implementation of the subject matter described in this specification, or any combination of one or more such back-end, middleware, or front-end components. The components of the system may be interconnected by any form or medium of digital data communication, e.g., a communication network. The communication network may include, for example, any one or more of a LAN, a WAN, the Internet, and the like. Further, the communication network may include, but is not limited to, for example, any one or more of the following network topologies, including a bus network, a star network, a ring network, a mesh network, a star-bus network, tree or hierarchical network, or the like. The communications modules may be, for example, modems or Ethernet

cards.

(40) Computer system **900** may include clients and servers. A client and server are generally remote from each other and typically interact through a communication network. The relationship of client and server arises by virtue of computer programs running on the respective computers and having a client-server relationship to each other. Computer system **900** may be, for example, and without limitation, a desktop computer, laptop computer, or tablet computer. Computer system **900** may also be embedded in another device, for example, and without limitation, a mobile telephone, a PDA, a mobile audio player, a Global Positioning System (GPS) receiver, a video game console, and/or a television set top box.

(41) The term “machine-readable storage medium” or “computer readable medium” as used herein refers to any medium or media that participates in providing instructions to processor **905** for execution. Such a medium may take many forms, including, but not limited to, non-volatile media, volatile media, and transmission media. Non-volatile media include, for example, optical or magnetic disks, such as data storage device **915**. Volatile media include dynamic memory, such as memory **910**. Transmission media include coaxial cables, copper wire, and fiber optics, including the wires that comprise bus **920**. Common forms of machine-readable media include, for example, floppy disk, a flexible disk, hard disk, magnetic tape, any other magnetic medium, a CD-ROM, DVD, any other optical medium, punch cards, paper tape, any other physical medium with patterns of holes, a RAM, a PROM, an EPROM, a FLASH EPROM, any other memory chip or cartridge, or any other medium from which a computer can read. The machine-readable storage medium may be a machine-readable storage device, a machine-readable storage substrate, a memory device, a composition of matter effecting a machine-readable propagated signal, or a combination of one or more of them.

(42) As the user computing system **900** reads data, information may be read from the data and stored in a memory device, such as the memory **910**. Additionally, data from the memory **910** servers accessed via a network the bus **920**, or the data storage **915** may be read and loaded into the memory **910**. Although data is described as being found in the memory **910**, it will be understood that data does not have to be stored in the memory **910** and may be stored in other memory accessible to the processor **905** or distributed among several media, such as the data storage **915**.

(43) While the above discussion primarily refers to microprocessor or multi-core processors that execute software, one or more embodiments are performed by one or more integrated circuits, such as application specific integrated circuits (ASICs) or field programmable gate arrays (FPGAs). In one or more embodiments, such integrated circuits execute instructions that are stored on the circuit itself.

(44) Those of skill in the art would appreciate that the various illustrative blocks, modules, elements, components, methods, and algorithms described herein may be implemented as electronic hardware, computer software, or combinations of both. To illustrate this interchangeability of hardware and software, various illustrative blocks, modules, elements, components, methods, and algorithms have been described above generally in terms of their functionality. Whether such functionality is implemented as hardware or software depends upon the particular application and design constraints imposed on the overall system. Skilled artisans may implement the described functionality in varying ways for each particular application. Various components and blocks may be arranged differently (e.g., arranged in a different order, or partitioned in a different way), all without departing from the scope of the subject technology.

(45) It is understood that any specific order or hierarchy of blocks in the processes disclosed is an illustration of example approaches. Based upon implementation preferences, it is understood that the specific order or hierarchy of blocks in the processes may be rearranged, or that not all illustrated blocks be performed. Any of the blocks may be performed simultaneously. In one or more embodiments, multitasking and parallel processing may be advantageous. Moreover, the separation of various system components in the embodiments described above should not be

understood as requiring such separation in all embodiments, and it should be understood that the described program components and systems can generally be integrated together in a single software product or packaged into multiple software products.

(46) The subject technology is illustrated, for example, according to various aspects described above. The present disclosure is provided to enable any person skilled in the art to practice the various aspects described herein. The disclosure provides various examples of the subject technology, and the subject technology is not limited to these examples. Various modifications to these aspects will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the generic principles defined herein may be applied to other aspects.

(47) A reference to an element in the singular is not intended to mean “one and only one” unless specifically so stated, but rather “one or more.” Unless specifically stated otherwise, the term “some” refers to one or more. Pronouns in the masculine (e.g., his) include the feminine and neuter gender (e.g., her and its) and vice versa. Headings and subheadings, if any, are used for convenience only and do not limit the invention.

(48) The word “exemplary” is used herein to mean “serving as an example or illustration.” Any aspect or design described herein as “exemplary” is not necessarily to be construed as preferred or advantageous over other aspects or designs. In one aspect, various alternative configurations and operations described herein may be considered to be at least equivalent.

(49) As used herein, the phrase “at least one of” preceding a series of items, with the term “or” to separate any of the items, modifies the list as a whole, rather than each item of the list. The phrase “at least one of” does not require selection of at least one item; rather, the phrase allows a meaning that includes at least one of any one of the items, and/or at least one of any combination of the items, and/or at least one of each of the items. By way of example, the phrase “at least one of A, B, or C” may refer to: only A, only B, or only C; or any combination of A, B, and C.

(50) A phrase such as an “aspect” does not imply that such aspect is essential to the subject technology or that such aspect applies to all configurations of the subject technology. A disclosure relating to an aspect may apply to all configurations, or one or more configurations. An aspect may provide one or more examples. A phrase such as an aspect may refer to one or more aspects and vice versa. A phrase such as an “embodiment” does not imply that such embodiment is essential to the subject technology or that such embodiment applies to all configurations of the subject technology. A disclosure relating to an embodiment may apply to all embodiments, or one or more embodiments. An embodiment may provide one or more examples. A phrase such as an embodiment may refer to one or more embodiments and vice versa. A phrase such as a “configuration” does not imply that such configuration is essential to the subject technology or that such configuration applies to all configurations of the subject technology. A disclosure relating to a configuration may apply to all configurations, or one or more configurations. A configuration may provide one or more examples. A phrase such as a configuration may refer to one or more configurations and vice versa.

(51) In one aspect, unless otherwise stated, all measurements, values, ratings, positions, magnitudes, sizes, and other specifications that are set forth in this specification, including in the clauses that follow, are approximate, not exact. In one aspect, they are intended to have a reasonable range that is consistent with the functions to which they relate and with what is customary in the art to which they pertain. It is understood that some or all steps, operations, or processes may be performed automatically, without the intervention of a user. Method clauses may be provided to present elements of the various steps, operations, or processes in a sample order, and are not meant to be limited to the specific order or hierarchy presented.

(52) All structural and functional equivalents to the elements of the various aspects described throughout this disclosure that are known or later come to be known to those of ordinary skill in the art are expressly incorporated herein by reference and are intended to be encompassed by the included clauses. Moreover, nothing disclosed herein is intended to be dedicated to the public

regardless of whether such disclosure is explicitly recited in the clauses. No clause element is to be construed under the provisions of 35 U.S.C. § 112 (f) unless the element is expressly recited using the phrase “means for” or, in the case of a method, the element is recited using the phrase “step for.” Furthermore, to the extent that the term “include,” “have,” or the like is used, such term is intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term “comprise” as “comprise” is interpreted when employed as a transitional word in a clause.

(53) The Title, Background, and Brief Description of the Drawings of the disclosure are hereby incorporated into the disclosure and are provided as illustrative examples of the disclosure, not as restrictive descriptions. It is submitted with the understanding that they will not be used to limit the scope or meaning of the clauses. In addition, in the Detailed Description, it can be seen that the description provides illustrative examples, and the various features are grouped together in various embodiments for the purpose of streamlining the disclosure. This method of disclosure is not to be interpreted as reflecting an intention that the included subject matter requires more features than are expressly recited in any clause. Rather, as the clauses reflect, inventive subject matter lies in less than all features of a single disclosed configuration or operation. The clauses are hereby incorporated into the Detailed Description, with each clause standing on its own to represent separately patentable subject matter.

(54) The clauses are not intended to be limited to the aspects described herein but are to be accorded the full scope consistent with the language of the clauses and to encompass all legal equivalents. Notwithstanding, none of the clauses are intended to embrace subject matter that fails to satisfy the requirement of 35 U.S.C. § 101, 102, or 103, nor should they be interpreted in such a way.

Claims

1. A system, comprising: a controller; a handheld device in electronic communication with the controller, wherein the handheld device comprises a housing, wherein the housing defines an internal cavity, and wherein the housing defines an orifice providing access to the internal cavity; a trigger comprising an external surface and an internal surface, wherein the trigger is oriented to cover the orifice providing access to the internal cavity; a transfer member oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the internal surface of the trigger; a force sensor oriented in the internal cavity and engaged to a distal end of the transfer member and the internal surface of the trigger; a transfer roller oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the distal end of the transfer member; a cam oriented in the internal cavity and configured to indirectly engage the transfer member; and a motor oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the cam.
2. The system of claim 1, wherein the motor comprises a rotational motor configured to cause the cam to rotate about an axis.
3. The system of claim 1, wherein the transfer member comprises a proximal end, wherein the proximal end is coupled to the internal surface of the trigger, and wherein a coupling interface between the transfer member and the trigger is configured to permit a rotation at the coupling interface.
4. The transfer member of claim 3, wherein a first section of the distal end of the transfer member engages the force sensor and a second section of the distal end of the transfer member is coupled to the transfer roller.
5. The system of claim 1, further comprising an encoder, wherein the encoder is configured to convert at least rotary position to electronic signals.
6. The system of claim 1, further comprising a gear train coupled to the motor and the cam, wherein the gear train is configured to adjust a rotational speed or a torque applied to the cam by the motor.
7. The system of claim 1, wherein the trigger comprises a Hall effect sensor, wherein the Hall effect

sensor provides data regarding a simulated action in an augmented reality/virtual reality environment.

8. A system, comprising: a handheld device, wherein the handheld device comprises a housing, wherein the housing defines an internal cavity, and wherein the housing defines an orifice providing access to the internal cavity; a trigger comprising an external surface and an internal surface, wherein the trigger is oriented to cover the orifice providing access to the internal cavity; a transfer member oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the internal surface of the trigger; a force sensor oriented in the internal cavity and engaged to a distal end of the transfer member and the internal surface of the trigger; a transfer roller oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the distal end of the transfer member; a cam oriented in the internal cavity and configured to indirectly engage the transfer member; a motor oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the cam; and a controller in electronic communication with the handheld device, wherein the controller is configured to: receive, via the force sensor, a force input from the trigger; determine, based on the force input, a response force to be applied to the transfer member; and cause the motor to initiate a first rotation, transferring a rotational force through the cam and applying the response force to the transfer member.

9. The system of claim 8, wherein the motor comprises a rotational motor configured to cause the cam to rotate about an axis.

10. The system of claim 8, wherein the transfer member comprises a proximal end, wherein the proximal end is coupled to the internal surface of the trigger, and wherein a coupling interface between the transfer member and the trigger is configured to permit a second rotation at the coupling interface.

11. The transfer member of claim 10, wherein a first section of the distal end of the transfer member engages the force sensor and a second section of the distal end of the transfer member is coupled to the transfer roller.

12. The system of claim 8, further comprising an encoder, wherein the encoder is configured to convert at least rotary position to electronic signals.

13. The system of claim 8, further comprising a gear train coupled to the motor and the cam, wherein the gear train is configured to adjust a rotational speed or a torque applied to the cam by the motor.

14. The system of claim 8, wherein the trigger comprises a Hall effect sensor, wherein the Hall effect sensor provides data regarding a simulated action in an augmented reality/virtual reality environment.

15. A system, comprising: a handheld device, wherein the handheld device comprises a housing, wherein the housing defines an internal cavity, and wherein the housing defines an orifice providing access to the internal cavity; a trigger comprising an external surface and an internal surface, wherein the trigger is oriented to cover the orifice providing access to the internal cavity; a transfer member oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the internal surface of the trigger; a force sensor oriented in the internal cavity and engaged to a distal end of the transfer member and the internal surface of the trigger; a transfer roller oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the distal end of the transfer member; a cam oriented in the internal cavity and configured to indirectly engage the transfer member; a motor oriented in the internal cavity and coupled to the cam; a gear train coupled to the motor and the cam, wherein the gear train is configured to adjust a rotational speed or a torque applied to the cam by the motor; and a controller in electronic communication with the handheld device, wherein the controller is configured to: receive, via the force sensor, a force input from the trigger; determine, based on the force input, a response force to be applied to the transfer member; and cause the motor to initiate a first rotation, transferring a rotational force through the cam and applying the response force to the transfer member.

16. The system of claim 15, wherein the motor comprises a rotational motor configured to cause the cam to rotate about an axis.

17. The system of claim 15, wherein the transfer member comprises a proximal end, wherein the proximal end is coupled to the internal surface of the trigger, and wherein a coupling interface between the transfer member and the trigger is configured to permit a second rotation at the coupling interface.
 18. The transfer member of claim 17, wherein a first section of the distal end of the transfer member engages the force sensor and a second section of the distal end of the transfer member is coupled to the transfer roller.
 19. The system of claim 15, further comprising an encoder, wherein the encoder is configured to convert at least rotary position to electronic signals.
 20. The system of claim 15, wherein the trigger comprises a Hall effect sensor, wherein the Hall effect sensor provides data regarding a simulated action in an augmented reality/virtual reality environment.
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